Groote Koninklijke Bazar

Abstract

The Groote Koninklijke Bazar (Big Royal Bazar) was a department store in The Hague. Dirk Boer, the owner of the company, started trading in Asian arts from 1825. In 1843, he opened his store at the Zeestraat.

History

The Groote Koninklijke Bazar was a department store for Asian wares in The Hague. Its owner Dirk Boer (1803-1877) began selling goods in 1825 and opened a store on Zeestraat in 1843. The store sold Asian items, mainly from Japan, China, Persia and the Ottoman Empire, as well as from the Dutch East Indies. The buyers were private individuals, including King Willem II, as well as museums, such as the Royal Cabinet of Curiosities and the then Rijks Ethnografisch Museum. After Boer's death, the business continued under new owners. It finally closed its doors in 1927.

Provenance research

It is not known whether the business records of Groote Koninklijke Bazar have been preserved. Separate archive documents are held in various archives. The Municipal Archives of The Hague has some photographs of the store's interior showing many objects. The Wereldmuseum Leiden archive contains correspondence with Groote Koninklijke Bazar regarding purchases.

Related Aids

- The trade in objects from a colonial context
- Royal Cabinet of Curiosities
- Wereldmuseum Leiden
- Kunsthandel Van Lier

Primary sources

Archive:

> *Nationaal Archief 2.09.46 Inventaris van de dossiers Naamloze en Besloten Vennootschappen van het Centraal Archief Vennootschappen van het Ministerie van Justitie, opgeheven vóór 1983, 1820-ca. 1945 When public and later private limited companies were formed, their articles of association required approval by the Ministry of Justice. The content of the files could range from a single opinion to a pack of documents comprising articles of association, appeals, opinions, royal decrees and correspondence.*
>
> https://www.nationaalarchief.nl/onderzoeken/archief/2.09.46/invnr/%40index

Archive:

Nationaal Archief 3.17.13.03 Inventaris van het archief van de Kamer van Koophandel en Fabrieken voor 's-Gravenhage: Handelsregister 1921-1969 Documents from the Business Register (Chambers of Commerce) of the province of South Holland. Business name: Koninklijke Bazar voorheen D. Boer en Zonen NV, Groote. File number HA-000014 /1. Includes a set of commercial files.

https://www.nationaalarchief.nl/onderzoeken/archief/3.17.13.03/invnr/%401

Archive:

Noord-Hollands Archief 476 Rijksmuseum en rechtsvoorgangers - inventory number 836-839 Declarations of goods and services supplied, 1813, 1824-1831. The Royal Cabinet of Curiosities purchased items from Dirk Boer, which are mentioned in this archive.

https://hdl.handle.net/21.12102/567C414E21CB4FC48C35085331D8A768

Archive:

Stadsarchief Rotterdam / Collectie Th. Haanebrink en Alex de Haas 4062 Poster of the Koninklijke Bazar from 1926.

https://hdl.handle.net/21.12133/8F98F272DE4045309EA6FA218A2664FC

Secondary sources

Article:

Dam, Peter van. "The Royal Bazar of Dirk Boer: early Japonism in The Hague around 1840." Andon 7 no. 25 (1987): 16–19. Article about Dirk Boer's store from the Journal of Japanese Art.

https://rkd.nl/library/89731

Article:

Baird, Christina and Backx-Palsgraaf, Helen. "Viewing Japan and China through Dirk Boer's Panorama, 1835–1838." Journal of the History of Collections 32, Issue 1 (March 2020): 119–128. This article discusses Dirk Boer's activities that predate the Groote Koninklijke Bazar and highlights a Chinese/Japanese panorama as an illustration of the interest in China and Japan that existed in the Netherlands in the 1830s.

https://doi.org/10.1093/jhc/fhy052

Book:

Keblusek, Marika. Japansch Magazijn: Japanse kunst en cultuur in 19de-eeuws Den Haag. Leiden: Hotei, 2000. Book about a previous store owned by Dirk Boer.

https://search.worldcat.org/title/902181455?oclcNum=902181455, ISBN 9789074822251

Book:

Wap, J.J.F. De Koninklijke Bazar van den Heer D. Boer aan de Scheveningsche Zeestraat te 's Gravenhage. 's Gravenhage: Belinfante, 1854. _

https://search.worldcat.org/title/67736999, WorldCat 67736999

Catalogue:

Boer, Dirk. Kabinet van Japansche, Chineesche en Oostersche zeldzaamheden, antiquiteiten en rariteiten ter bezigtiging opengesteld te Scheveningen: voorafgegaan van eene schets der zeden en gewoonten der Japanners, en gevolgd door eene beschrijving van dit Kabinet. 's Gravenhage, 1841. Description of the Royal Bazar by Dirk Boer.

https://search.worldcat.org/title/67826958, WorldCat 67826958

Relevant Data

TO BE FILLED

first edited by Wiebe Reints as original_author on 2024-05-03
last edited by Wiebe Reints as original_author on 2025-12-23